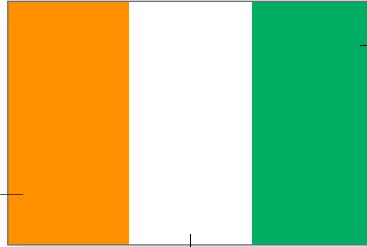


Ivory Coast

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** December 3, 1959 **Usage:** National and Civil

The design is modeled on the French *Tricolore*

Orange represents the savannah grasslands



Green recalls their coastal forests

White represents the country's rivers

Africa



Ivory Coast was originally part of French West Africa. It became independent in its own right on August 7, 1960.

After independence, Ivory Coast formed a loose alliance of West African states. The flags of these states were influenced both by the pan-African colors first used by Ghana, and also by the model of the French *Tricolore*, the flag of the former colonial power.

ALLIANCE OF WEST AFRICAN STATES

The colors chosen for Ivory Coast's flag were also used by Niger, with which Ivory Coast had an alliance (the resemblance to the colors of Ireland is coincidental). They were intended to symbolize the following: orange represents the savannah grasslands, white the rivers, and green the coastal forests. Another

interpretation is that they symbolize progress, hope, and national unity. The flag was adopted in 1959, just prior to independence.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms, which has a green shield charged with an elephant's head, is based on the emblem of the *Rassemblement Démocratique Africain*, the dominant political party at the time of independence. Originally the elephant's head was on a blue shield, but this was altered in 1964 to green, to match the national flag. The shield is supported by two palm trees. Behind is a rising sun. On a scroll at the base of the arms is the title of the state, "*Republique de Côte d'Ivoire*."